

A

When / As soon as

The meaning of these two time expressions is almost the same, but **as soon as** suggests something more immediate or important.

I'll phone my uncle **when** / **as soon as** I get home.

As soon as / **When** you've finished this exercise, you can go home.

Common mistakes

I'll see you **when** I **get** there. (NOT I'll see you when I ~~will~~ get there.)

We don't use a future form after *when* / *as soon as*.

B

Two things happening at the same time

Violet got ready **while** I cooked the dinner. [two long actions]

The accident happened **while** I was on my way to work. [a longer action 'on my way to work' and a short action 'the accident'; we can also use **when** or **as** here.]

I saw him (**just**) **as** I came out of the office. [two short actions happening at the same time; we can also use **when** here]

C

One thing after another

We met the others in the café, and **then** / **after that** / **afterwards** we went to the match.

I talked to Joe, and **afterwards** [at a later time but usually the same day] I came home.

I was in Caracas for three months, and **then** / **after that** I went to Colombia.

After my visit to New York, I decided to have a rest.

We had something to eat **before** going out.

Common mistakes

After **seeing** the film, we went home.
(NOT After see the film, we went home.)

D

A sequence* of actions

We had a really nice holiday. **First of all** / **First** we spent a few days in St Moritz. **After that** / **Then** we drove down the coast and stayed in Portofino for a week. **Finally**, we went back to Switzerland to stay with my uncle. (*Finally* is used here to introduce the last thing in a list.)

* one action after another, and so on

E

At first ... eventually

To begin with, the two girls got on very well when they shared the flat. But after **a while** [a period of time], they started arguing about various things, and **eventually** [finally, after a long time or a lot of problems] Lauren walked out and found a new place.

At first I enjoyed the classes, but after a while it got a bit boring, and **in the end** [finally, after a period of time or thought] I left.

F

A list of reasons

We can use **firstly** / **for one thing** / **for a start** to introduce a first reason for something, and then **secondly** / **besides** / **anyway** to add a further reason.

A: What's wrong with her new dress?

B: **Firstly**, it's a horrible colour, and **secondly**, I don't think it suits her.

A: Why can't we go out tonight?

B: Well, **for one thing** / **for a start**, I've got a lot of work – and **besides** / **anyway**, I can't afford it.

Exercises

92.1 Find five more pairs of words/phrases that are similar in meaning.

then for one thing when besides finally at first for a start
in the end after that to begin with as soon as anyway

then / after that
.....
.....
.....

.....
.....
.....

92.2 Choose the correct word to complete the sentences. Sometimes both are correct.

- 1 I rang my mum when / while I was waiting for my train.
- 2 I'll give them your message as soon as I get / will get there.
- 3 Maria cleaned the kitchen as / while I did the bathroom.
- 4 Before leave / leaving they went to an exhibition in a little gallery.
- 5 We can have lunch when / as soon as we've finished this.
- 6 The phone rang while / just as I was shutting the front door.
- 7 We spent the morning in the park and after that / afterwards we went home for lunch.
- 8 The letter arrived while / just as we were having lunch.
- 9 I met the others when / as I was on my way to the station.
- 10 After to clean / cleaning my room, I was exhausted.

92.3 Complete the dialogues.

- 1 A: Why do you want to stay in this evening, when we could go to Karl's party?
B: Well, for one thing, I'd like to watch a programme on TV, and, I don't think it'll be a very good party.
- 2 A: What did you do in Portugal?
B: Well, we flew to Lisbon and spent a few days there. we took the train down to Lagos and spent a week on the Algarve with a couple we met in London. And we went to Faro and flew back from there.
- 3 A: Did Matt enjoy his time in India?
B: Well, I think he found it difficult because the food and weather are so different. But after a he got used to it, and didn't want to come home.
- 4 A: Why can't the company pay for me to go to the conference?
B: Well, the boss doesn't seem to think it's very important, and we're too busy at the moment to give anyone time off work.
- 5 A: Did the new company do well?
B: Yeah, it did very well. But then the manager left, and after a they started losing money., they had to close down.

92.4 Complete the sentences in a suitable way.

- 1 We had a game of table tennis and afterwards we went for a drink.
- 2 I'll give you the answers to this exercise when
- 3 I'll text you as soon as
- 4 I must remember to lock the back door before
- 5 He thinks he dropped the letter as
- 6 I worked with a partner in class. I looked up half of the words while
- 7 We were in a traffic jam for hours but eventually
- 8 If we phone his home, he probably won't be there. Anyway,